DECO3500 TEAM 17 SHAREHOUSE EXPENSES

The Weekly Split

A shared ritual for agreeing on household expenses

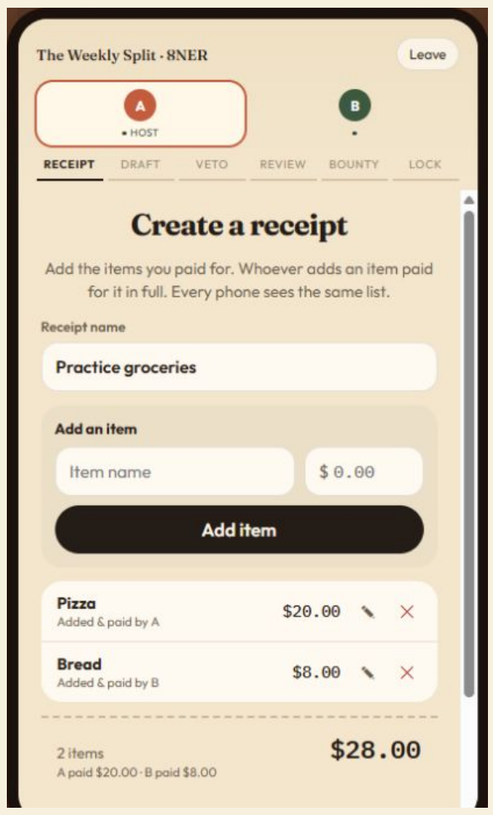
In sharehouses, questioning a small grocery cost can feel more awkward than paying it. Our opportunity is to make that disagreement easier to raise.

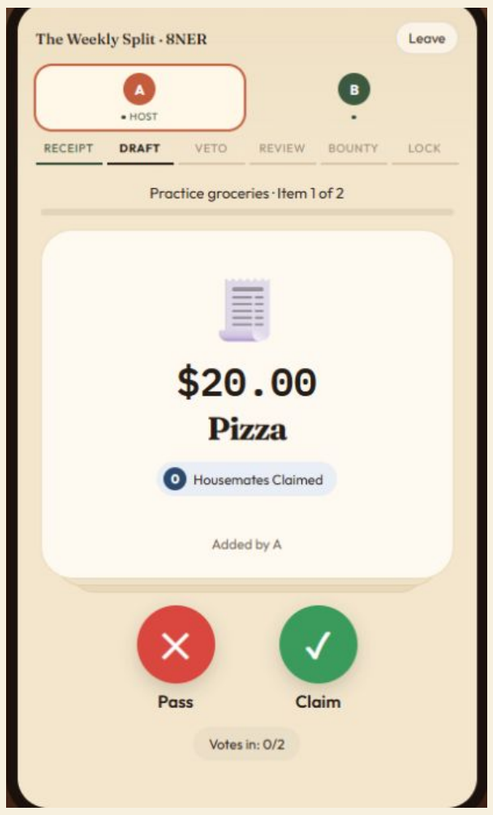
01 INTERVIEWS SHAPED THE OPPORTUNITY

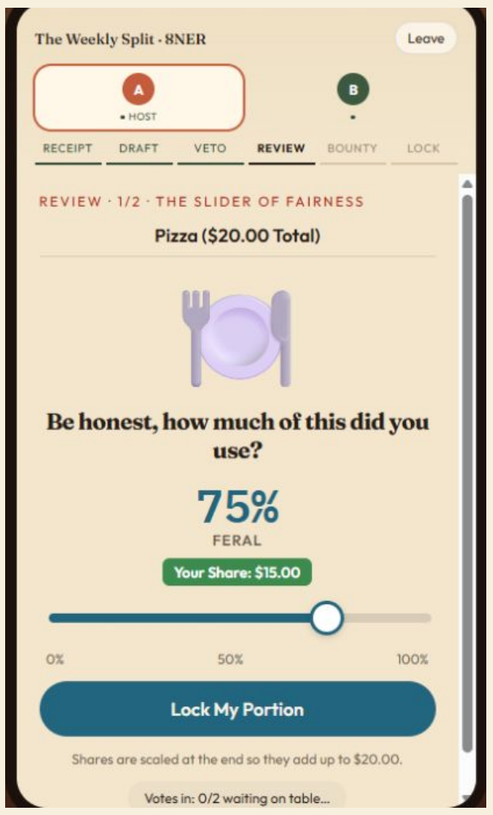
17 problem interviews: people described accepting small unfair costs to avoid tension. We designed item-level choices and review before repayment, so housemates can express their use without opening with an accusation. [1]

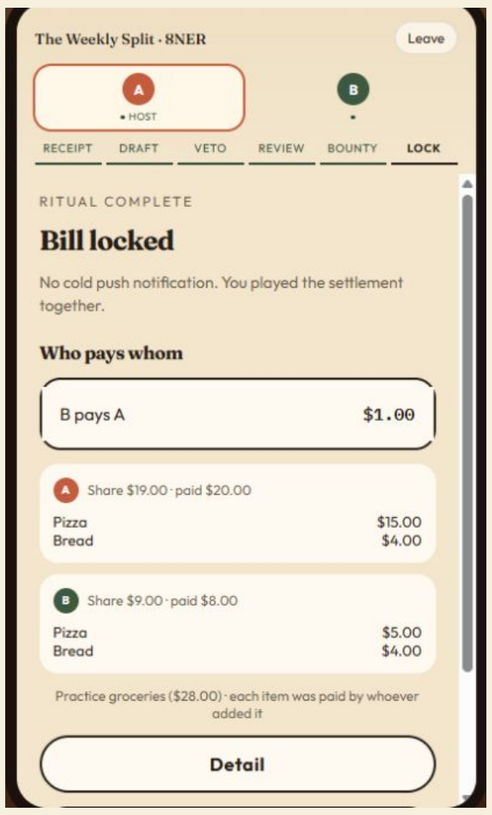
Supporting survey: 29 of 35 respondents at least occasionally paid equally despite consuming much less. [2]

02 2–8 HOUSEMATES, ONE LIVE TABLE









1 Create a receipt

Add purchases you paid for. Everyone contributes items and prices to one shared receipt.

2 Claim / Pass

Choose which items you use. Claimants share each item's cost.

3 Review together

Raise a concern, discuss it, then slide your estimated use from 0–100%.

4 Explain

See who pays whom. Open Detail to trace paid amounts and item shares.

03 WHY SOCIAL & MOBILE COMPUTING?

Social: the 3C model

Cooperation: build one receipt. Communication: claims and review express use and concerns. Coordination: live votes and readiness pace the group. Awareness: see who has responded. [6, 8]

Mobile: the household context

A Sunday kitchen-table ritual fits shared shopping, household relationships and weekly routines. Separate phones support individual input during a same-time session. [7]

04 USER TESTS CHANGED THE DESIGN

Users rejected orphan penalties. We removed them.

Randomly assigning an unclaimed expense felt unfair to the person selected. We removed the orphan-item penalty game after user tests. Unclaimed expenses now split evenly; agreement still matters. [3, 4, 5]

Keep item-level choices

In one four-person household test, all four completed the main flow without hints; three traced an item line behind their amount. [3]

Visibility can create pressure

Earlier tests exposed veto inference. Lettered seats and hidden responses now support discretion; social privacy still needs evaluation. [3, 5, 6]

NEXT: household groups in context; observe participation, pressure and repeated use

[1] Interviews [2] Survey [3] Team user tests [4] Team decision [5] Prototype
[6] Fuks et al., 3C (Week 2) [7] Context, Weeks 1 & 6 [8] Erickson, IxDF

Join a table. Try your own split.

malonewayne.github.io/Deco3500-Team-17/

Team research: github.com/MaloneWayne/Deco3500-Team-17